

African Experience 2

Introduction

This course will introduce you to the reality of doing business in sub-Saharan Africa (SSA). As a subcontinent that is home to nearly 1.2 billion people and 49 countries (based on an expansive geographic definition), SSA defies easy generalizations and instead demands that attention be paid to the myriad political, economic, and social differences among its peoples and nations. Nevertheless, there are also myriad themes that unite Africa, many of which are positive such as the continent's immense entrepreneurial energy and the overwhelming support among its peoples for electoral democracy. On the other hand, most African nations face serious headwinds in the forms of demographic hurdles like rapidly rising youth and urban populations and economic challenges like shifting economies toward value-added production and increasing the skills and competitiveness of local labour. Our intention is to provide students with a nuanced understanding of the risks and rewards of doing business in SSA and highlight how the next generation of global business leaders can make a meaningful contribution to the frequently misunderstood "African growth story."

Course Objectives & Outcomes

- Develop a nuanced understanding of SSA and its people, politics, and markets.
- Create an intellectual toolkit for assessing the challenges and opportunities of operating in emerging and frontier markets.
- Enhance cross-cultural awareness and abilities.
- Practice robust decision-making in highly uncertain and rapidly changing environments.

Competencies

Basic:

CB6. Possess and understand knowledge that provides a basis or opportunity to be original in the development and/or application of ideas, often in a research context.

CB7. The students know how to apply the knowledge acquired and their ability to solve problems in new or unfamiliar environments within broader (or multidisciplinary) contexts related to their area of study.

CB8. The students can integrate knowledge and face the complexity of formulating judgments based on information that, being incomplete or limited, includes reflections on social and ethical responsibilities linked to the application of their knowledge and judgments.

General:

CB9. Students know how to communicate their conclusions and the knowledge and ultimate reasons that support them to specialized and non-specialized audiences in a clear and unambiguous way.

CG6. Prioritize objectives, schedule activities appropriately, and execute them accordingly. Students possess the learning skills that allow them to continue studying in a way that will be largely self-directed or autonomous.

CG7. Identify and deal effectively with information relevant to their work.

CG9. Know how to place the company in its international context and within the framework of globalization.

Specific:

CE01. Apply a structured and rigorous process of analysis of business situations and decision-making that incorporates the following phases: diagnosis of the problem, selection of criteria, identification of alternatives, weighted analysis, and identifying an alternative with its consequent action plan.

CE02. Prepare structured, synthetic, and clear executive reports for the analysis and decision-making of business situations.

CE07. Apply the techniques and skills in handling situations with others, to effectively manage teams and resolve conflicts in multicultural environments.

CE13. Understand the opportunities associated with Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR). Being able to develop a strategic CSR plan using a variety of planning tools.

CE18. Analyze markets and new business opportunities. Design rigorous, relevant, and effective market research. Understand with depth and put into practice the concepts of segmentation, targeting, and positioning.

CE19. Analyze consumer behavior using empirical analysis tools and theoretical models of human behavior.

Evaluation

The course grade will be determined as of IESE policies. It will be calculated as follows:

Description	Percentage
Individual reports (SE1)	30%
Team reports (SE1)	40%
Performance in class (SE2)	30%

Personal reflections essay (30%)

Your personal reflections essay should be two pages in narrative form. While the length of the essay is short, we will look for genuinely thoughtful observations regarding your experience in Nairobi. We will expect each essay to cover personal learnings (i.e., preconceptions about Africa/Kenya/Nairobi, what surprised you in the positive and negative, how has your thinking changed as regards the developing world) and commercial learnings (i.e., as a future business leader what surprised you about Africa/Kenya/Nairobi as a marketplace, where do you see the most opportunity for business growth, what did you learn that will most impact how you approach your professional development). Be creative in this essay – we will expect you to be reflective, observant, and self-critical regarding your thinking as regards Africa and other developing markets. This exercise is intended to flex those intellectual muscles that atrophy in an age of PowerPoint but are prized by business leaders who look beyond the standard PowerPoint “pitch.” **Due date: March 9th 2026, 11:00 am (CET) via Virtual Campus.**

“Solution the Problem” exercise and “IESE Nairobi Challenge” award (40%)

Prior to our week in Nairobi, you will be assigned to a team. You will then be paired with a group of MBAs of the same size from Strathmore Business School. The exercise is intended to put you into the mind of a start-up founder or impact investor. You are aiming to seize on an idea that will not only be successful but also create a genuine public good. This exercise is non-traditional by design and it gives each group great flexibility to deliver their final product. We have seen groups make the most of this flexibility and submit highly innovative and thoughtful proposals – and we have seen groups that clearly haven’t taken the process seriously. We obviously are hoping that all of you will fall into the former category!

The IESE and SBS cohorts will first meet virtually on December 10th prior to face-to-face collaboration in Nairobi – see session 1 in the course Outline.

Throughout the exercise, we ask you to:

- Engage in a robust discussion between IESE & SBS peers, prepare to analyze, debate, and strategize.
- Decide on a path forward regarding the social good you hope to achieve and the social enterprise that you feel is the best vehicle to reach that objective.
- Establish a workplan for the weeks following the Nairobi module.

There will be multiple sessions in Nairobi for your group to compare notes on your observations and work towards alignment on a particular issue. Throughout the exercise, you will be expected to work in partnership with your SBS peers to jointly develop the “solution to a problem.”

Following the Nairobi visit, teams will need to coordinate the creation of a presentation (a maximum of 5 slides) that will be judged by a panel of faculty. The deadline for submission of your presentation is **March 9th 2026, 11:00 am (CET)** via Virtual Campus - at the same time as your personal reflections essay. We will then select approximately 3–4 of the most impressive proposals for presentation to the entire class on March 16 at 12:45 at IESE Barcelona. One of these teams will be chosen as the winner of the 2026 Nairobi Challenge award.

These presentations should cover the following:

- Define the problem and its impacts.
- Discuss any ongoing public/private/public-private efforts to solve the problem. If nothing exists in the marketplace, why?
- Propose a novel solution that could be the foundation for a future commercial endeavor.

The goal of this exercise is not to develop a foolproof business plan (although that would be a superb outcome). Instead, we want you to think about how private capital (potentially in partnership with government or non-profits) can tackle key human development issues facing residents of Nairobi and many other cities like it across the world. And, these ideas can also be implemented by a major corporation (start-ups aren't the only vehicles for social entrepreneurship). More details on the final presentations will be delivered in Nairobi. Due date for group presentations: **March 9th 2026, 11:00 am (CET)** via Virtual Campus.

Course Outline

Session 1	SBS-IESE Solution the problem (StP) first class: Presentation of StP
Objectives:	1. First opportunity to engage with SBS students and jointly listen to the concept of the StP. 2. Get all the team members from SBS and IESE introduced to each other. 3. StP at its core is to create a model that addresses an issue of "social good."
Material:	· Reading (executive summary and introduction) - World Economic Forum, "The State of Social Enterprise: 2024." https://www3.weforum.org/docs/WEF_The_State_of_Social_Enterprise_2024.pdf · Reading - Harvard Business Review, "Two Keys to Sustainable Social Enterprises," May 2015.
Instructions:	1. Prepare yourself to introduce yourself to the team consisting of IESE and SBS students. 2. Think about your first impressions when you think about the phrases "social enterprise," "social entrepreneurship," and "social innovation." 3. Prepare yourself to observe and analyze as soon as you arrive in Nairobi/Kenya. 4. Ask SBS peers what they see as a possible model that address an issue of "social good." 5. Prepare yourself to be challenged by your SBS peers. This exercise is part of everyday operations in a multinational - cross-border collaboration where you will need to recognize cultural differences and also simple challenges like distance and technology.

Session 2

Looking Beyond the Business Case - Critical Historical, Political, and Diplomatic Themes in Sub-Saharan Africa

Objectives:

The objectives of this session are to provide an understanding of the critical interplay of politics and economics in Africa.

1. The colonial legacy: setting the framework for understanding Africa's post-independence world.
2. What are the frameworks in which to view post-colonial governance in Africa? What is "neo-patrimonialism" and how has it impacted governance in contemporary SSA?
3. Do the old models for understanding the connections between politics and economics remain valid for SSA today when seen in the light of political-economic models like that of China and Singapore and threats to democracy in the West?

Material:

- Article: "It's Africa's Century, For Better or Worse," Foreign Policy, 13 May 2022.
- Article: "Anarchy Unbound: The New Scramble for Africa," The New Statesman, 16 August 2023.
- Article: "The World is becoming more African," The New York Times, 28 October 2023.
- Article: "President Trump's "Carrot and Stick" Approach to Africa," Center for Strategic and International Studies, 8 July 2025.

Instructions:

Read the materials in preparation for the lecture.

Session 3

The Entrepreneur View - Thriving in an Emerging/Frontier Market. A panel of local entrepreneurs

Objectives:

Africa is home to a new breed of entrepreneurs. In this panel, we will try to discuss:

1. Where does innovation come from in Africa?
2. How do you overcome the infrastructural deficit?
3. How do you overcome the political barriers?
4. How do you fight for and manage talent?
5. Can you both "do good" and build a financially sound business?

Material:

- Article: "A Profile of Entrepreneurship in Africa," pp 23-33, AfDB report on Entrepreneurship and Free Trade, December 2021 (pp 27-37; optional but encouraged).

Instructions:

Read the materials in preparation for the lecture.

Session 4

Exploring Marketing Strategies for Africa - Indomie

Objectives:

To gain insight into how opportunities emerging from local culture can be translated into brand-building opportunities for businesses in Africa. In particular:

1. How cultural branding through social media applies to consumer markets in Africa.
2. How to craft social media and digital marketing strategies that are relevant to countries facing an economic downturn.
3. Lessons from internationalizing a brand across various African countries.

Material:

- Case: Indomie Noodles in Africa: lessons on digital and cultural branding (Emerald Emerging Markets Case Studies, Vol. 8, No.1, 2018).
- Article: Africa's consumer market potential: Trends, drivers, opportunities, and strategies," Brookings Africa Growth Initiative, December 2018. (pp 4-17; optional but encouraged).

Instructions:

Study the Indomie Noodles in Africa case and try to answer the following questions:

1. How would you evaluate the strength of the Indomie brand in Nigeria and why?
 2. Why is Indomie's market share decreasing in Nigeria?
 3. Why are consumption levels low in Northern Nigeria?
 4. How would you assess the steps followed by Dufill in building the Indomie brand over the years?
 5. What social media and digital marketing strategy should Dufill use to increase consumption levels in Northern Nigeria?
 6. Any quick comparisons between the Indomie brand marketing approach and other countries outside Africa?
 7. Any 'social impact' issues discernible from the Indomie case?
 8. Key lessons on marketing in Africa.
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Session 5

SBS-IESE Solution the problem (StP) second class: Experiential learning

Objectives:	1. Meet your SBS peers in-person. 2. Agree with your SBS peers on 2 possible models that address an issue of "social good." 3. Test your initial assumptions and hypotheses with both your IESE and SBS peers.
Material:	· Report: "Social enterprise: constraints and opportunities - evidence from Vietnam and Kenya," (skim) Overseas Development Institute, 2014. link
Instructions:	1. As soon as you arrive in Nairobi, please pay close attention to the rhythms of life in the city. The goal is to begin asking questions about how life could be improved via a sustainable commercial enterprise. The problems can be acute with severe consequences (how can women walk at night more safely) to the seemingly mundane (can taxi journeys be more efficient) and all points in between. 2. Maintain this focus throughout the visit: observe, question, and hypothesize. Then be prepared to bring these thoughts to discussions with your joint IESE/SBS group. 3. Make sure that you have at the end of the meeting with your SBS peers agreed on possible models that address an issue of "social good" with the objective to work on those the next days in Nairobi.

Session 6

Business Models & Local Innovation in Emerging Economies - The case of Safaricom

Objectives:

In this session, we will look at how innovative business models have arisen in Africa, both as a response to the continent's unique commercial climate and also as proof of the world-class innovation and entrepreneurial energy that exists on the continent. We will pay particular attention to:

1. How to understand and elicit customer needs in emerging economies.
2. The impact of new technology to facilitate new business models in Africa.
3. The involvement of different stakeholders in a successful business model that has direct social benefits.
4. To what extent the innovations are sustainable and transferable across countries in Africa.

Material:

· General overview: Africa: Unlocking the Fintech Potential. Boston Consulting Group, 2023.

Instructions:

Study the enclosed material and prepare for a discussion on the following questions:

1. Innovation and Entrepreneurship: How Safaricom has maintained its leadership position in the African market and its response to new entrants like PayPal and Google Pay...

Article: "Safaricom's Strategy in Response to PayPal and Google Pay" The Business & Financial Times.

2. Talent Development: The strategies Safaricom employs to cultivate and retain top talent in Africa's competitive landscape.

Article: "Safaricom as a Top Employer" TechAfrica News.

3. Purpose-Driven Leadership: Safaricom's role in addressing the needs of the bottom of the pyramid and balancing profit with social impact, reflecting the alignment with humanism by contributing to the common good.

Article: "Safaricom's Social Impact Through M-Pesa Foundation" M-Pesa Foundation.

4. Learning from Successes and Failures: The importance of past successes and failures in shaping Safaricom's future strategies, particularly in expanding into new markets like Ethiopia.

Article: "Safaricom's Expansion into Ethiopia" Ventures Africa.

Session 7**Managing Organizational Challenges**

Objectives:	Corruption seems to be a standard topic when discussing doing business in Africa (and in the world in general). In this session, we will try to understand the social, economic and ethical aspects of corruption in Africa, whether the rhetoric matches the reality, and try to understand what defines ethical business in Africa.
Material:	· Case: Diana Mensah (A). · Article: "State Capture - How the Gupta Brothers Hijacked South Africa Using Bribes Instead of Bullets", Vanity Fair, March 2019.
Instructions:	Prepare the case and be ready to give your suggestions on how to handle the situation.

Session 8**Savannah Discovery Kenya - Doing Well to Do Good?**

Objectives:	In this session, we will revisit another of the industries with potential in Africa: Tourism. 1. How can tourism be a growth sector for many African countries and how does it relate to conservation? 2. What is the role of government and communities in this industry? What are the opportunities for investments? 3. Are impact investing and venture philanthropy mutually exclusive? Which role can each have in funding sustainable business models?
Material:	· Case: "Savannah Discovery Kenya - Doing Well to Do Good." · Article: State of the Wildlife Economy in Africa: Kenya. ALU School of Wildlife Conservation (optional but encouraged).
Instructions:	Read the case and try to answer the questions raised in the case.

Session 9

Negotiation

Objectives:

This exercise will provide IESE and SBS students with the opportunity to see both sides of a typical business negotiation in Africa, in this case, focused on the purchase by a social enterprise of a large quantity of fertilizer from a manufacturer only recently established in Kenya. The objective will be to understand the cultural and commercial nuances that are most appropriate in an African market like Kenya. Furthermore, we hope that the lessons from this module will be applicable in all environments where cross-cultural understanding and communication are critical to commercial success.

Material:

- Case: to be distributed in class.
- Article: "How to Negotiate in Cross-Cultural Situations: Five Ways to Redefine Negotiation in Cross-Cultural Situations," Harvard Law School Program on Negotiation, 28 July 2022.

Instructions:

1. Understanding preconceptions/stereotypes that each side had in the negotiation.
2. Negotiation strategies that were most effective in reaching an agreement.
3. Frameworks for thinking about cross-cultural negotiations.

Session 10

Sanergy - Taking a Successful Model for Safe Sanitation to New Emerging Markets

Objectives:

1. This case will investigate how successful business models can arise in Africa in response to infrastructure challenges that may appear insurmountable and commercially unviable.
2. The challenges of launching an initially capex-intensive business model.
3. How should companies think about expansion strategies for emerging and frontier markets?
4. The risk vs. reward of tackling new geographic markets or doubling down on growth at home (or closer to home).

Material:

- Case: Sanergy - "Taking a Successful Model for Safe Sanitation to New Emerging Markets."
- Article: "How to attract private finance to Africa's development," World Bank Blogs, 16 August 2021. (optional but encouraged).

Instructions:

- Study the Sanergy case and try to answer the following questions:
1. What is it about Sanergy's business model or leadership team that allowed it to succeed in Kenya despite significant sectoral and market headwinds?
 2. What criteria should Sanergy use when deciding on geographic expansion?
 3. Which countries in Africa (or beyond) do you think Sanergy should enter?
 4. How should Sanergy position itself in the global agribusiness sector, particularly vis-à-vis established global players?
 5. What do you think the "end-game" should be for Sanergy's founders (i.e., further fundraising rounds, public listing, sale of the business)?
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Session 11

Kibera

Objectives:

We will visit a secondary school located in the heart of Kibera, one of Africa's most densely populated urban informal settlements with at least 250,000 people living in an area of just 2.5 square kilometers. In many ways, Kibera is a microcosm of the immense challenges facing Africans, their governments, and those businesses serving African markets. However, settlements like Kibera also hum with entrepreneurial energy and our goal is to expose students, albeit briefly, to this vibrant community. IESE MBAs and the secondary school students will perform some musical numbers. We encourage any IESE students who would like to showcase their talents to let the course organizers know beforehand.

Material:

- Podcast: "The Slumlords of Nairobi," The Documentary Project - BBC, 10 March 2019.

Takeaways:

- Provide first-hand exposure to the realities of life in the high-density informal settlements that are home to the majority of Africans living in and around urban areas.
- Recognize that life in communities like Kibera is much more multifaceted than the snapshot images presented in mainstream media.
- Allow students to see for themselves how Africa's informal economy operates and the entrepreneurial spirit that thrives in communities like Kibera.

Potential questions for students:

1. "What's your story? What has been the most challenging thing in your life so far? Why?"
2. "What do you love most about your community?"
3. "If you see your friends/family move out of Kibera & start to live a better lifestyle, what do you feel? How do you think they got there? Could that be you?"
4. "Did/do you enjoy school? What parts do you like/dislike? What's your favourite subject?"
5. "If you could have any superpower, what would it be? Why?"
6. "If someone would give you one million Kenyan Shillings (Euro), what would you do with it?"

Session 12

Company Visit - Sanergy

Objectives:	The purpose of this visit is to give students first-hand exposure to the operations of a successful start-up venture, particularly one that is successfully delivering a major public good. They will be able to see for themselves the unique challenges and rewards of doing business in Africa and to engage with company leaders.
Material:	· Article: "Scaling Up Essential Services in African Cities," 2022, African Development Bank and the United Nations. (pp 9-19 - optional but encouraged).

Session 13

China, the Gulf States, and Other New Investors Writing the Africa Growth Story

Objectives:	The session will focus on the enormous impact of investment and trade flows between Africa and China, the Gulf States, and other new entrants to the African new market. 1. The roots of Chinese investment in Africa during the Cold War. 2. The massive scale and impact of Chinese investment in SSA over the past 20+ years. 3. The transition from the "no questions asked" attitude toward Chinese investment of many African governments in the 2000s to their much more sophisticated/wary approach today. 4. What is driving the entry of new investors in Africa, particularly from Gulf States like the UAE and other regional powers like Turkey?
Material:	· Article: "How China is winning the race for Africa's Lithium," Financial Times, 3 April 2023. · Article: "China-Africa Relations," Chatham House, 18 January 2023. · Article: "Trump's New Africa Policy Focuses on Deals... and China," China global South Project, 6 June 2025. · Article: "A new economic partnership is emerging between Africa and the Gulf states," World Economic Forum, 28 April 2025.
Instructions:	Read the materials in preparation for the lecture.

Session 14

The Investor View: Private Equity and Venture Capital in East-Africa

Objectives:	In this session, we will discuss the state of private equity and venture capital and investment opportunities in Africa, with a focus on East Africa. In particular: 1. Review the structure and fundamentals of African venture and private equity markets. 2. What are the investment trends? 3. What are the roles of private equity and venture capital firms?
Material:	· Article: "Venture Capital in Africa Report: Driving Africa's Economic Growth," April 2022, Africa Private Equity and Venture Capital Association (AVCA). (pp 3-10 - optional but encouraged).
Instructions:	Read the materials in preparation for the lecture.

Session 15

SBS-IESE Solution the problem (StP) third class Experiential Learning

Objectives:	1. In this second class in Nairobi with your SBS peers you will have to define the final model you want to provide the Solution to a problem for a "social good." 2. Develop the main economic and impact drivers for your model. 3. Define the working plan for the joint SBS IESE team for the coming weeks to be ready for the timeline and hand-ins.
Instructions:	1. The team will agree on the final model and on research requirements based on the outcomes of sessions one and two. 2. Spend time on really agreeing with your peers on the 2-3 main economic and impact drivers for your model. 3. We will leave it to your group to decide how your work plan will be developed, the roles to be held by individual students, etc. However please agree on a concrete plan for the coming weeks.

Session 16

African Consumer Markets: Retail Safari Site Visit

Objectives:	Understand the reality of African consumer markets, including street markets and organized distribution, through on-the-ground exposure to Nairobi's vibrant commercial environs.
Material:	· Article: Berwart, A., Lago A., A. (2020). African Markets and Consumers. IESE, PN-509-E (optional but encouraged).
Instructions:	Students will organize in groups and will be given 2 hours to visit a street market and a supermarket. 1. Student teams will be asked to obtain information about prices, organizational structure of the markets and commercial approaches. 2. Specific information will be provided at the beginning of the sessions.

Session 17**Keynote**

Our week in Nairobi will be capped by closing remarks from a prominent business leader who can offer a unique perspective on Africa's commercial challenges and potential.

Session 18**SBS-IESE Solution the problem (StP) Final class Experiential Learning****Objectives:**

1. Engage with the up to three group StP submissions selected as the most promising.
2. Those groups should be prepared to pitch their idea to the rest of the class as if they were a group of potential investors.

Instructions:

1. All groups will have submitted a 5-page pitch that outlines the social good they are hoping to deliver and the social enterprise they hope to launch.
 2. Up to four teams will present, each team will have 10 minutes.
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Content

- Understand the key socio-economic, political, and business themes at work in contemporary SSA. A particular goal throughout will be to reinforce the understanding that SSA is a hugely diverse region where the most successful companies and entrepreneurs treat each country/market as unique.
- Discuss the principal drivers behind successful commercial operations in SSA - particularly agribusiness, consumer goods, tourism, financial services, and natural resources.
- Learn from the direct experience of both local African and international entrepreneurs, managers, and investors.
- Understand the unique features of working in Africa, including cultural, legal, compliance, and HR challenges.

Bibliography

Principal Overview Reading

In addition to the syllabus, we recommend the following book, which is a highly readable yet rigorous analysis of SSA's post-colonial history. While it is not mandatory, the book provides very useful historical and political context to the subcontinent's recent history.

Somerville, Keith. *Africa's Long Road Since Independence: The Many Histories of a Continent* (2016).

Important: The order of sessions may be changed subject to the availability of local professors and invited speakers. The reader will only contain cases and academic readings. Additional readings can be accessed via the provided links. Other supplemental resources may be delivered through the Virtual Campus course platform or via email.

Professor's Biography

Todd Johnson



Part-time Temporary Academic Staff of Entrepreneurship

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Master of International Public Policy, Johns Hopkins SAIS BA in Political Science, University of Kansas.

Todd Johnson has worked for over 25 years in the risk analysis and corporate strategy space, starting his career in 1997 as an intelligence analyst at the Central Intelligence Agency before transitioning into the private sector in 2005. Throughout much of his career, he has lived in and focused on SSA.

His commercial roles have included serving as a managing partner and advisory board member at Sofala Partners, a global functional leader at Standard Industries and General Electric, leader of a strategy cell that directly supported GE's former CEO Jeff Immelt, and as an intelligence analyst with the Central Intelligence Agency. He has been based in Washington DC, New York City, London, Johannesburg, and Barcelona.

Todd has extensive experience in developing frameworks for assessing and mitigating non-financial risks - with a particular focus on reputational, compliance, and political risks - in close coordination with M&A, Legal, and Government Affairs teams. These frameworks are most often used as part of the due diligence and corporate strategy process linked to partnerships, investments, acquisitions, divestments, and new market entry. He also regularly engages in the design of thought leadership campaigns, including GE's high-profile backing of President Obama's 2014 US-Africa Leaders' Summit.

He has a Master of International Public Policy with Honours from the Johns Hopkins University School of Advanced International Studies and a Bachelor of Arts in Political Science with Distinction from the University of Kansas. He has previously taught in the graduate program at New York University's Center for Global Affairs, where he developed the syllabus for an introductory course in African politics.

Professor's Biography

Heinrich Liechtenstein



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MBA, IESE Business School, University of Navarra.

Bachelor in Business and Economic Sciences, University of Graz.

Certified European Financial Analyst.

Professor Liechtenstein holds a PhD in Managerial Science and Applied Economics from The Economics School of Vienna, Austria, a Master's degree in Business Administration from IESE Business School, and a BSc in Business Economics from the University of Graz.

Professor Liechtenstein specializes in entrepreneurial finance, management of wealth, governance of entrepreneurial families and Impact Investing. He is a co-author of several publications on private equity. Professor Liechtenstein lectures in the MBAs and Executive Programs. As a consultant, he collaborated with leading families and financial institutions and serves on the board of family-controlled foundations. Prior to his academic career, Professor Liechtenstein was engaged in LGT dealing with ultra-high net-worth individuals. He also advised families within the Boston Consulting Group and established and sold two successful businesses.

Professor's Biography



Prof. James Njuguna

Full-time lecturer at Strathmore University Business School. PhD in Business Administration (Marketing) from the University of Nairobi. MBA (Marketing) from the University of Nairobi. Postgraduate Diploma (Mass Communication) from University of Nairobi. BA Hons. (Government) from the University of Nairobi. Diploma in Marketing from the University of London. Harvard Business School – Exec. Program in Leadership, Change and Organisational Renewal (LCOR).

James Njuguna is a Full-time lecturer at Strathmore University Business School where he lectures and does management consultancy and research in Corporate Strategy, Strategic Management, Global Marketing, Entrepreneurial Marketing, Consumer Behavior, Marketing Strategy and planning, Services Marketing, Sales Management, Global Competitive Strategy, Strategic Marketing Management, Marketing Research, Strategic Leadership, Strategic Entrepreneurship, Agribusiness, Energy, Executive Education and Public Relations & Communications, among other disciplines.

He transitioned over six years ago from the energy sector where he worked as a Senior Manager at Kenya Power & Lighting Company having served for 26 years in various managerial roles. His experience in the energy sector covered; Business Strategy Development and improvement, Business Restructuring, Business Process Reengineering, Change Management, Policy Formulation, Marketing, Customer Service, Public Relations and communications and Consultancy at local, regional, and international levels. This included forging business partnerships and projects with various stakeholders in other sectors such as banking, insurance, telecommunications, manufacturing, agribusiness, funding agencies, development partners, investors, and government organizations, among others. Prior to joining the energy sector, Dr Njuguna practiced freelance journalism, an interest that he has pursued to date including academic publishing.

He is also a member and former official of the Marketing Society of Kenya and Public Relations Society of Kenya as well as a member of the Chartered Institute of Marketing. Dr Njuguna is married with three children. His hobbies include reading, music, swimming, playing golf and travelling.

Learning Outcomes

These are the Learning Outcomes:

- Understand the international economic and social environment to assess opportunities and risks for business development in other countries. (OP01)
- Know the key elements of business sustainability and learn how to implement it within companies. (OP02)
- Interact as a company executive with primary internal and external stakeholders. (OP03)
- Explore funding sources for new businesses, such as crowdfunding, business angels, venture capital, and alternative stock markets. (OP06)
- Apply technological innovation and new digital infrastructures to business models. (OP08)
- Assess new businesses in their early stages for initial rounds of financing. (OP10)
- Conceptualize, design, analyze, and apply new business models. (OP12)
- Critically evaluate relevant information for improved decision-making. (R01)
- Integrate economic efficiency, ethical criteria of respect for human dignity, and planetary sustainability in decision-making. (R10)
- Lead diverse teams by optimizing resources and inspiring trust, which translates into commitment and autonomy for the rest of the team. (R11)
- Analyze the impact of business decisions from a general management perspective, operating within a global competitive context. (R22)
- Apply an entrepreneurial mindset, with a creative and open attitude, driving necessary changes with energy and personal responsibility. (R23)

Formative Activities

Time distribution for each formative activity:

Description	Hours
Sessions with the professor (AF1)	37h
Individual student work (AF2)	39h
Teamwork (AF3)	17h
Assessments & Exams (AF4)	7h

Sustainable Development Goals

This course encourages critical reflection on ethical and strategic decision-making, positioning sustainability as a central dimension of business leadership and management. It explores the social, environmental, and ethical implications of business choices, integrates sustainability principles in the discipline, and fosters systems thinking by highlighting the interdependence of social, ecological, and economic systems. Students are challenged to identify and assess key sustainability issues, developing a holistic and responsible perspective.

It addresses the following SDGs:

- SDG1. No poverty
- SDG3. Good Health and well-being
- SDG6. Clean water and sanitation
- SDG8. Decent work and economic growth
- SDG10. Reduced inequalities
- SDG12. Responsible consumption and production
- SDG16. Peace, justice and strong institutions